Briefing Session on 2025 HKDSE Geography Examination

30 Oct and 7 Nov 2025

香港考試及評核局
Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority

2025 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Year	2025	2024	2023	2022
No of candidates	SCH/ 1	**7 666**	7 464	7 098	7 460
	WG	**8 512**	8 186	7 603	7 942

2025 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

Level	2025	2024	2023	2022
5**	1.3	1.2	1.3	1.2
5*	4.7	5.0	5.1	4.9
5	12.2	12.0	12.5	12.5
4	35.6	37.1	37.7	37.3
3	64.9	65.4	63.2	62.8
2	87.7	89.9	88.4	88.0
1	96.8	97.2	97.9	97
U	3.2	2.8	2.1	3.0

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2025 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

Year	Mean (% mark)
2022	45.52
2023	48.3
2024	45.76
2025	**39.8**

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2025 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

Paper 1	
MCQ Statistics	
Mean (% mark)	11.9 (59.5)
Lowest	1
Highest	20

2025 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Paper 1							
	Q1 (18)	**Q2 (18)**	**Q3 (18)**	**Q4 (18)**	**Q5 (18)**	**Q6 (12)**	**Q7 (12)**	**Q8 (12)**
Mean Score *(% marks)*	4.11 *(22.8)*	7.96 *(44.2)*	5.69 *(31.6)*	10.72 *(59.6)*	6.25 *(34.7)*	2.68 *(22.3)*	3.02 *(25.2)*	2.56 *(21.3)*
Highest Score	**18**	**17**	**15**	**18**	**16**	**12**	**11**	**10**
Popularity (%)	---	28	22	86	64	38	41	18

2025 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Paper 2							
	Q1 (18)	**Q2 (18)**	**Q3 (18)**	**Q4 (18)**	**Q5 (12)**	**Q6 (12)**	**Q7 (12)**	**Q8 (12)**
Mean Score *(% marks)*	7.44 *(41.3)*	6.25 *(34.7)*	5.44 *(30.2)*	7.50 *(41.7)*	2.59 *(21.6)*	3.07 *(25.6)*	0.73 *(6.1)*	1.81 *(15.1)*
Highest Score	**18**	**18**	**16**	**17**	**12**	**11**	**5**	**11**
Popularity (%)	40	27	5	28	40	26	5	27

School Survey on 2025 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*The examination reflects the assessment **aims & objectives** stated in the **C & A Guide**.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
8.8%	73.7%	14.0%	2.6%	0.9%	0.0%

*The examination is well-balanced in terms of **curriculum coverage**.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
6.0%	74.4%	15.4%	3.4%	0.0%	0.9%

School Survey on 2025 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*An appropriate **balance** between questions testing **basic knowledge / skills & those testing higher-order skills.***

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
6.0%	71.6%	18.1%	2.6%	0.9%	0.9%

*The **wording** of the questions is clear & easily understandable.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
7.0%	70.4%	20.0%	1.7%	0.0%	0.9%

A Review of HKDSE Geography Assessment Frameworks

Year	Remarks	Major amendments
2025	Normal	FBQ: Compulsory
2026	Normal	FBQ: Compulsory
2027 onwards	Optimised AF	FBQ: Compulsory **(Module options: 2)**

Reminders for Candidates in 2026 Geography Examination

1. ***DO NOT*** *allow to use self-made transparent plastic sheets with gridlines in the examination*
2. ***DO NOT*** *use colour pencils, colour marker pens or highlighters*
3. ***CLEAR HANDWRITING*** *and* ***PAGE LAYOUT*** *are essential for accurate marking*
4. ***WRITE CLEARLY*** *by crossing out/ deleting all unwanted words*
5. *Mark carefully and accurately the* ***QUESTION NUMBER*** *on* ***EACH PAGE*** *of the Answer Book, especially in Sections C & D of Paper 1*
6. *Start* ***EACH*** *question (not part of a question) on a* ***NEW*** *page*
7. *Study carefully the 2026 Handbook for Candidates*

Review of Candidates' Performance

2025 HKDSE Geography
Paper 1

Section A

- The overall performance of candidates was about the same as last year.
- In Item 3, 36% of candidates chose Option B.
- The average gradient of the section of the footpath from the junction (110742) to spot height 495 (103745) is approximately _____.

A.	1:1.9	12%
B.	1:2.3	36%
C. *	1:2.7	36%
D.	1:3.1	16%

miscalculation of the average gradient

* Correct answer

Section A

- In Item 5, the most popular answer was Option D.
  - Which of the following is/are the location advantage(s) of the Kai Tak Cruise Terminal (1269 and 1369)?
    (1) proximity to Kwun Tong Typhoon Shelter
    (2) accessible by railway
    (3) deep waterfront

A.	(2) only	8%
B. *	(3) only	18%
C.	(1) and (2) only	24%
D.	(1) and (3) only	51%

* Correct answer

misunderstanding of the nature and function of a cruise terminal

Section A

- In Item 19, the most popular answer was Option C.
- Which of the following is the ecological impact brought about by climate change?

A.*	southward migration of biomes in the Southern Hemisphere	24%
B.	intensified coral bleaching in the polar region	33%
C.	more frequent extreme rainfall in Hong Kong	42%
D.	fewer forest fires in the Amazon rainforest	1%

* Correct answer

extreme rainfall is primarily a meteorological event, not an ecological impact

Section A

- In Item 20, the most popular answer was Option D.
  - How does tree planting mitigate the urban heat island effect?

    (1) increases evapotranspiration

    (2) absorbs more carbon dioxide

    (3) provides more tree shading

A.	(1) and (2) only	24%
B. *	(1) and (3) only	15%
C.	(2) and (3) only	22%
D.	(1), (2) and (3)	38%

candidates might have confused urban heat island effect with global warming

* Correct answer

Section B – Question 1

Compulsory fieldwork-based question

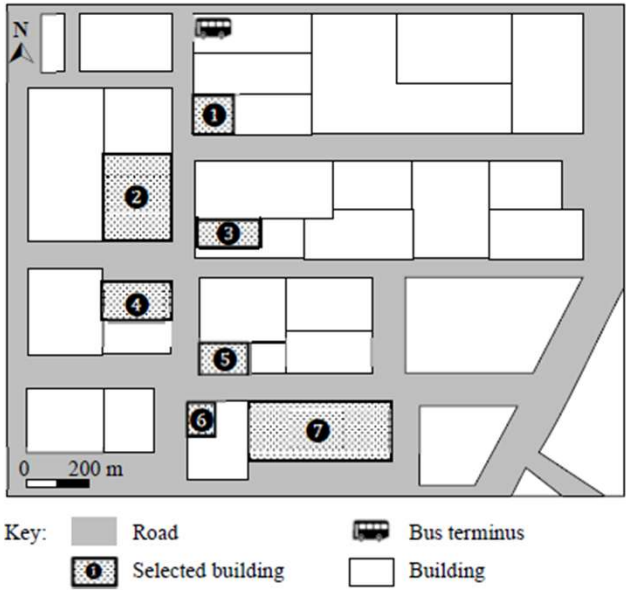
(a) Refer to Figures 1a and 1c.

(i) Identify the sampling method in selecting the buildings. Explain your answer. (2 marks)

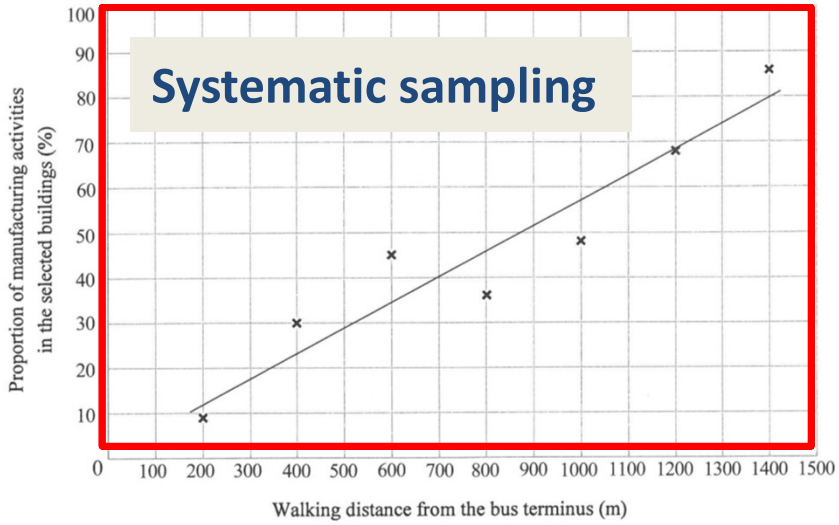
(ii) State one advantage and one disadvantage of the sampling method mentioned in (a)(i). (2 marks)

Poor

Satisfactory



- incorrectly named the method, e.g. random sampling, convenience or stratified sampling
- failed to identify the sampling method and justify their answers subsequently, leading to inaccurate explanations



- ✓ stated the advantages of the sampling method
- provided answers related to advantages and disadvantages of choosing the field study area instead

Section B – Question 1

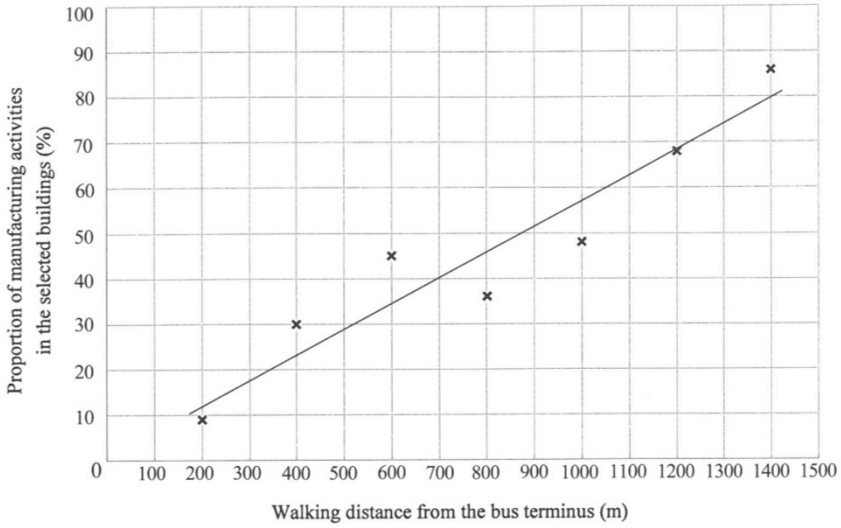
(b) Refer to Figure 1a, Table 1b and Figure 1c. Describe how to use the record sheet to find out the proportion of manufacturing activities in each selected building. (4 marks) **Poor**

Table 1b

Task: To investigate the number of manufacturing activities in each selected building

Type of activities	Number of companies
Food production and processing	
Office	
Garment and textile	
Warehouse	
Plastic product	

Figure 1c



Pay attention to the question words!

- ✓ stated counting as one of the procedures to find out the proportion of the manufacturing activities
- ○ commonly missed the step to classify the five types of activities into manufacturing and non-manufacturing
- ○ incorrectly classified office as a manufacturing activity
- ○ failed to use the total number of companies as the denominator in their calculations

Section B – Question 1

(c) Refer to Figure 1c.

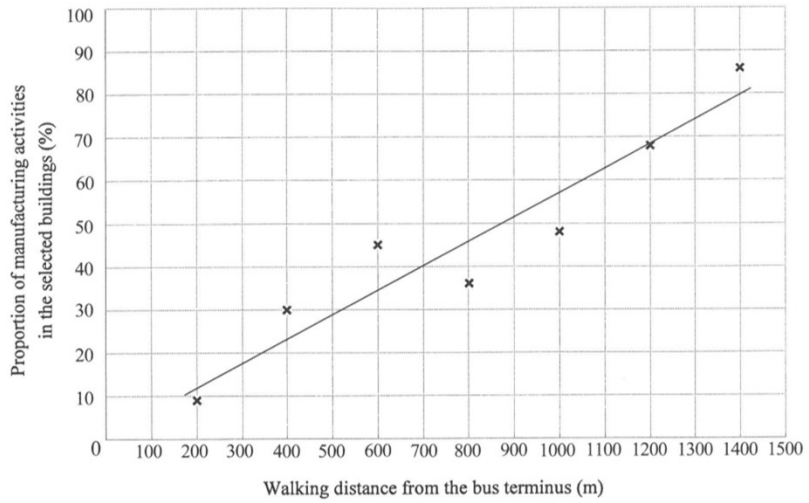
(i) Name the graphical presentation method shown in the figure. (1 mark) **Poor**

(ii) Draw a conclusion for this field study. How did you use the graphical presentation to reach your conclusion? (3 marks) **Fair**

- failed to identify the graph
- incorrectly named it as a line graph or point graph

Field Study Topic:
A study of the relationship between accessibility and the intensivity of manufacturing activities in industrial area X

Figure 1c



- ✓ correctly described the relationship between the walking distance from the bus terminus and the proportion of manufacturing activities
- ✓ accurately described the orientation of the best fit line
- failed to draw the conclusion correctly

Section B – Question 1

(d) Refer to the Figure 1a, Table 1b and Figure 1c. Describe and explain how other primary data would be collected to enrich the field study regarding the intensivity of manufacturing activities in Industrial area X. (6 marks)

Very Poor

- ✓ some candidates suggested relevant primary data to enrich the field study, e.g. air quality, noise level, the number of **heavy** vehicles
- ○ failed to explain the rationale behind their suggestions
- ○ many did not read the question carefully and respond accurately to the question
- ○ some proposed either secondary data or repeated data collection methods already stated in the question
- ○ included irrelevant content, such as methods to improve the reliability of existing data collection methods

General comments and recommendations (Section B)

- The performance of Section B was not satisfactory.
- Fieldwork skills extend beyond practical experience and involve critical tasks, e.g. organising data, effectively displaying data, and employing basic mathematical techniques.
- Candidates should exert effort in enhancing their skills on the five stages of enquiry-based fieldwork.

Stages of enquiry-based fieldwork

1. **Planning and preparation**
2. **Data collection**
3. **Data processing, presentation and analysis**
4. **Interpretation and conclusion**
5. **Evaluation**

Section C – Question 2 Popularity: 28%

(a) Refer to Figures 2a and 2b.

(i) Identify coastal landform feature X. (1 mark) **Very good**

(ii) Draw a series of annotated diagrams to explain the formation of coastal landform feature X. (4 marks) **Good**

- ✓ demonstrated a good under-standing of the formation of sea cliff
- ✓ annotated drawings related to the physical setting and wave erosion processes
- ○ some failed to label their drawings appropriately, e,g. location of a notch, and the alignment of low/high tide level with the notch

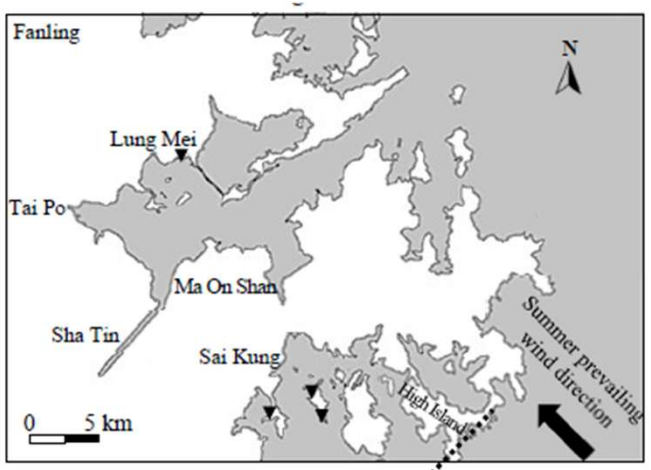
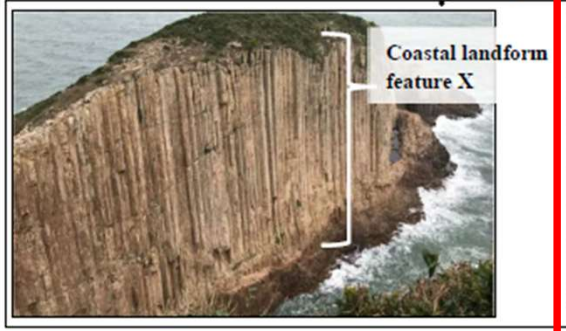


Figure 2b



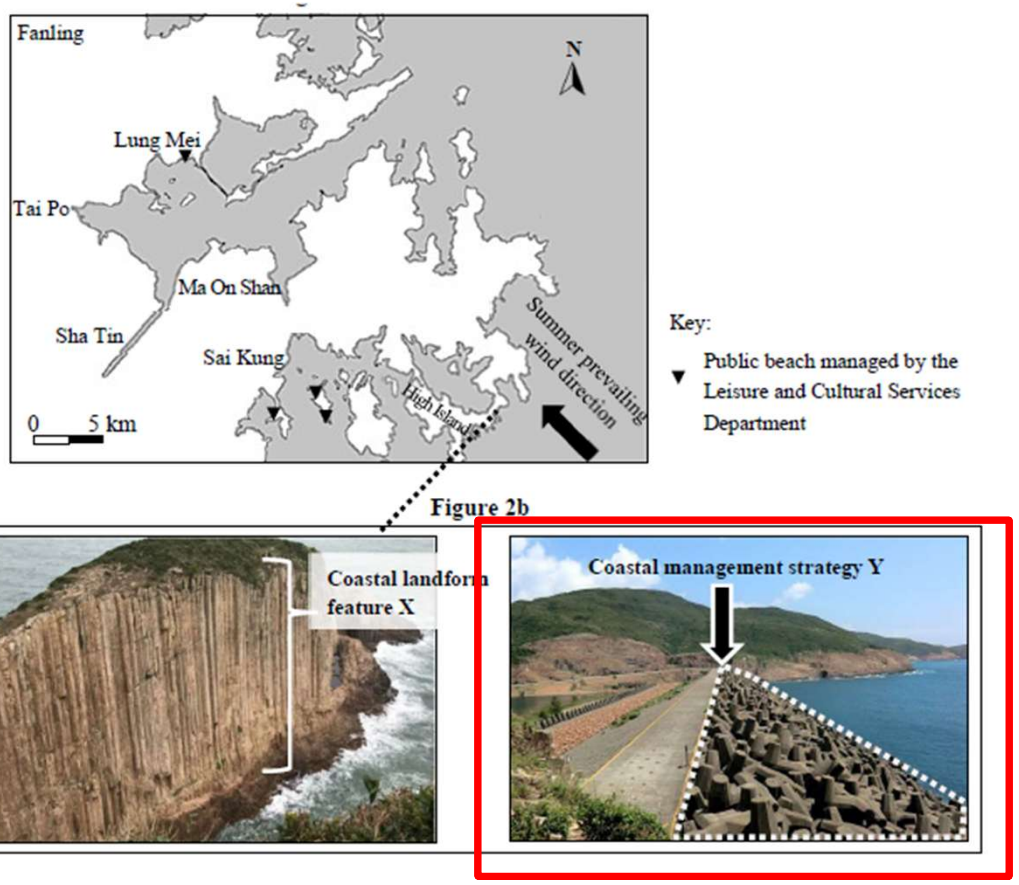


Section C – Question 2

(a) Refer to Figures 2a and 2b.

(iii) With reference to the physical setting of the area, explain why coastal management strategy Y is adopted. (5 marks) **Very good**

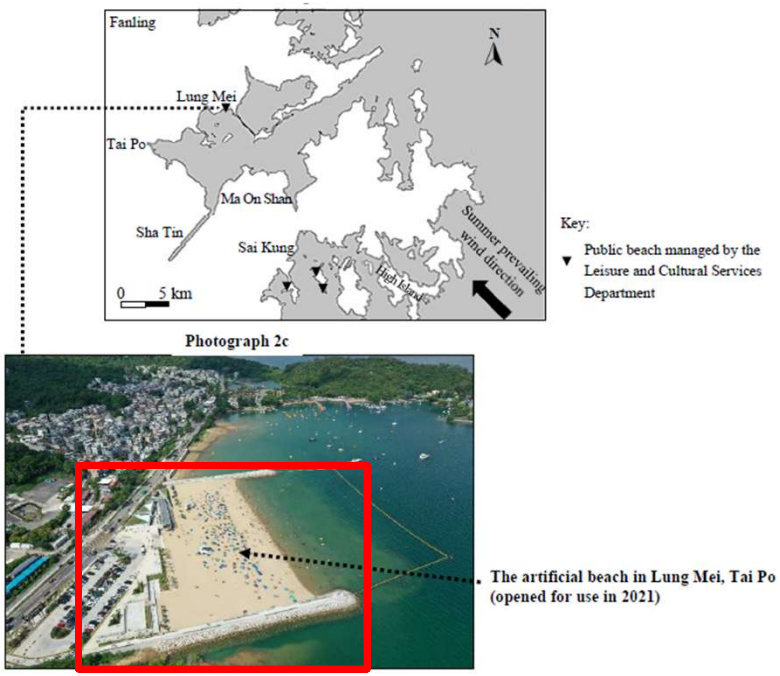
- ✓ identified relevant physical factors that contributed to strong wave erosion,
  e.g. exposed location, long fetch
- ○ incomplete explanation and direct copy from the figure, e.g. there is summer prevailing wind
- ○ misinterpreted the function of strategy Y, confusing it as reflecting wave energy rather than absorbing wave energy



Section C – Question 2

(b) Refer to Figure 2a, Photograph 2c and Figure 2d. Describe and explain the changes in the coastal environment brought about by the construction of the artificial beach in Lung Mei. (5 marks)

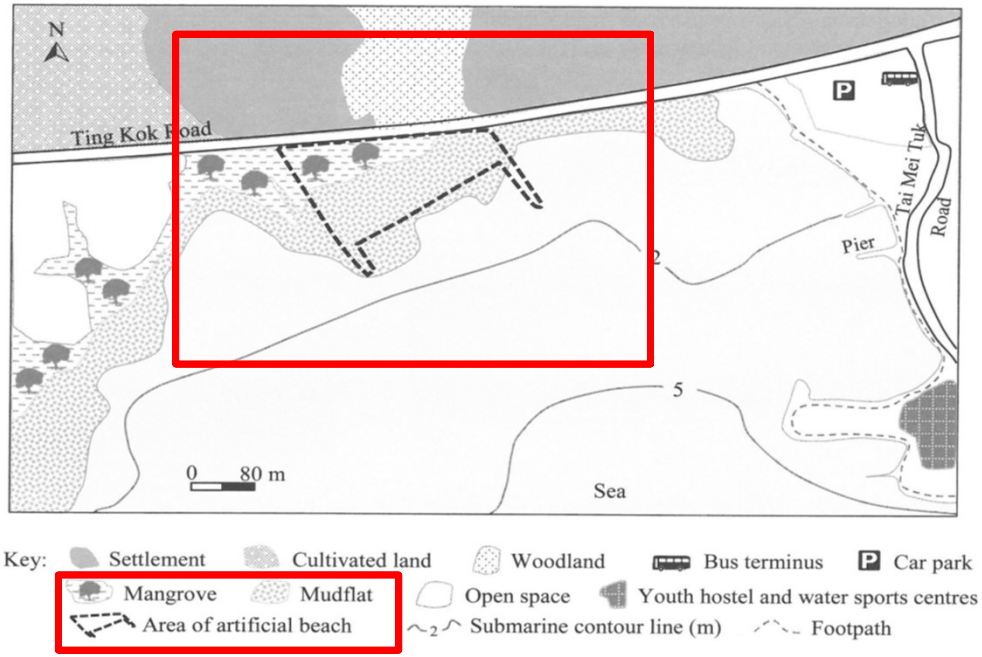
Fair



Photograph 2c

The artificial beach in Lung Mei, Tai Po (opened for use in 2021)

Figure 2d



- ✓ able to describe and explain about the changes in the coastal environment
- ○ did not refer to Photograph 2c and Figure 2d closely and gave irrelevant answers e.g. extinction of species
- ○ wrongly identified the coastal management strategy adopted as breakwaters

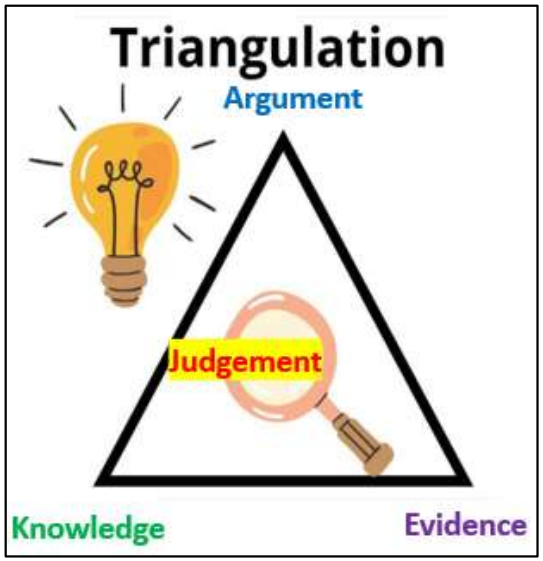
Section C – Question 2

(c) *As the population is increasing in New Territories East, it is suggested that the existing artificial beach in Lung Mei should be expanded.*

Refer to Figure 2a, Photograph 2c and Figure 2d. Discuss whether the expansion of the existing beach is appropriate. (4 marks) **Poor**

Marking criteria:

Logical and well-elaborated explanation/argument with reference to the information provided, demonstrating good knowledge and understanding of the appropriateness of expanding the Tai Po Lung Mei beach to meet the needs, with appropriate judgement

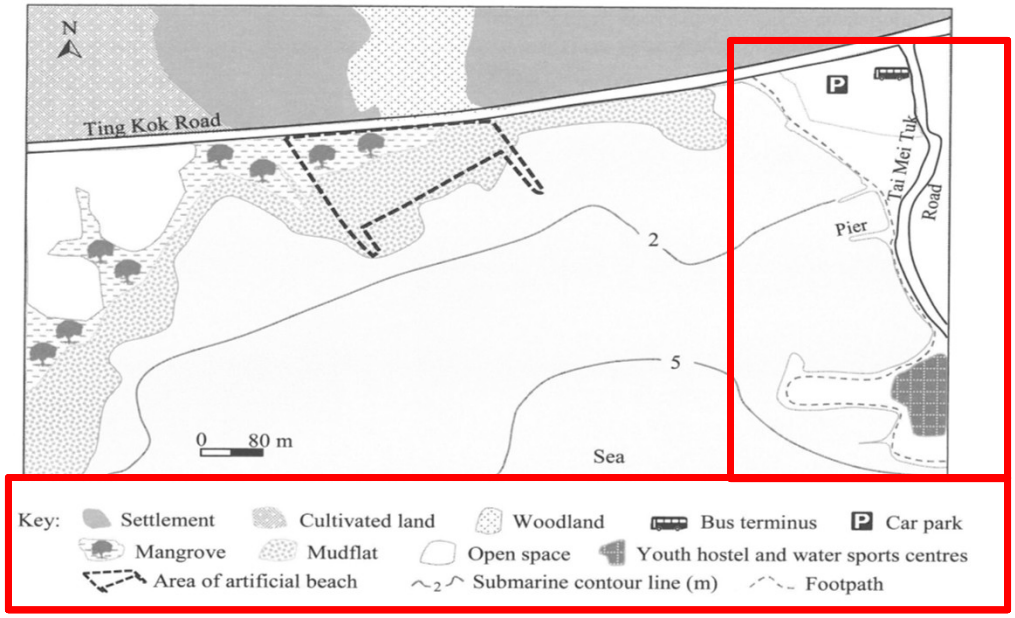


Section C – Question 2

✓ identified the favourable factors of expanding Lung Mei artificial beach in terms of accessibility and existing local infrastructure nearby

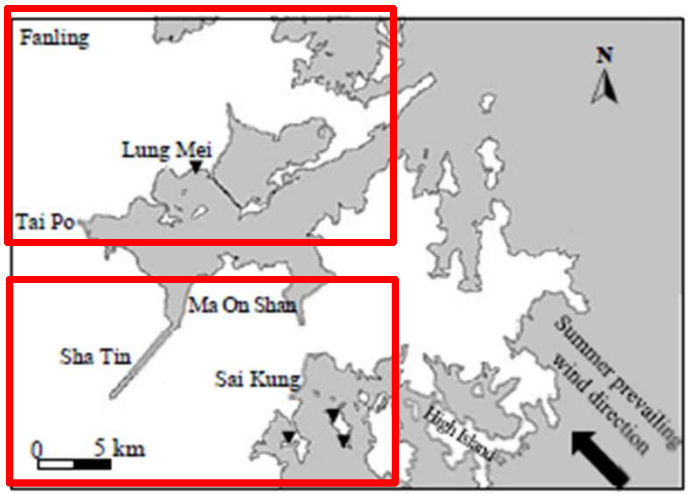


The artificial beach in Lung Mei, Tai Po (opened for use in 2021)



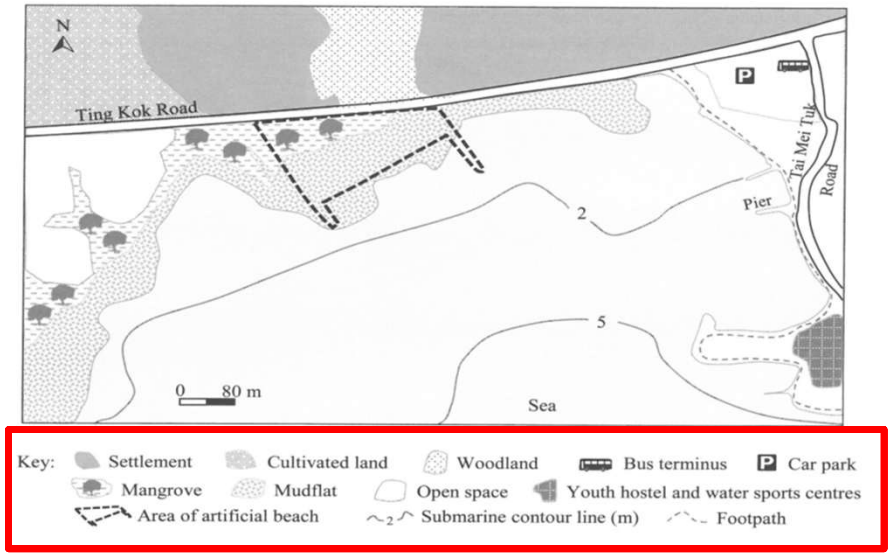
Section C – Question 2

- did not fully refer to ‘the population is increasing in New Territories East’
- failed to consider the location and the number of beaches in the New Territories East
- overlooked the critical factors to the planning and development of coastal environments,
  e.g. physical setting characteristics for developing more public beaches or expanding existing artificial beach



Key:

▼ Public beach managed by the Leisure and Cultural Services Department



Section C – Question 3 Popularity: 22%

(a) Refer to Figure 3a and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

(i) Describe the urban problems found in area X. (3 marks)

✓ provided relevant and appropriate descriptions of urban problems in area X, e.g. urban decay, overcrowding

Good

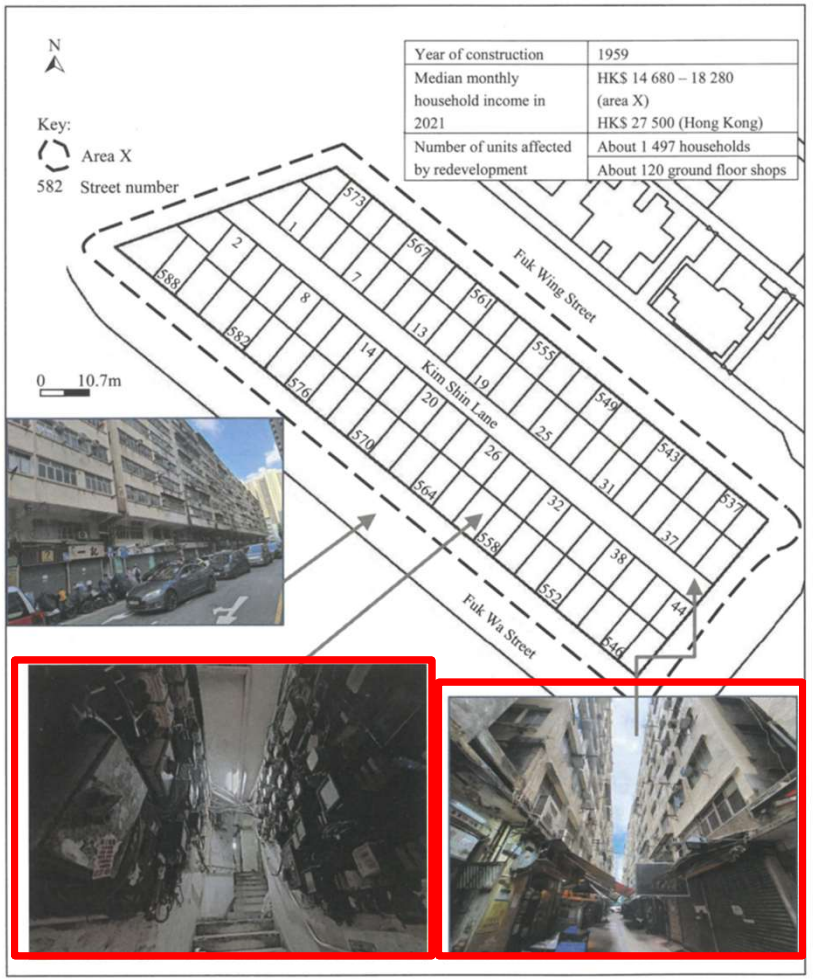
(ii) Area X is planned for redevelopment. Explain why other urban renewal strategies are not applicable to area X. (2 marks)

✓ few were able to explain why the other urban renewal strategies are not applicable in area X, e.g. buildings have no historical value

- many did not read the questions carefully
- some provided reasons which did not address the question, e.g. the appropriateness of redevelopment: improving the living environment, solving urban decay

Poor

Figure 3a



Section C – Question 3

(b) Refer to Figure 3a, Photograph 3b and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

(i) What are the possible adverse impacts of redevelopment on the community in area X? (3 marks) **Fair**

(ii) Suggest how such impacts could be minimised. (3 marks) **Poor**

- ✓ generally proposed some adverse impacts, e.g. higher land rent
- ○ some overlooked the term 'adverse impact' in the question and named positive impact instead
- ○ some ideas were too general or incomplete, e.g. resettlement of residents (the lost of social ties?)

Year of construction	1959
Median monthly household income in 2021	HK$ 14 680 – 18 280 (area X) HK$ 27 500 (Hong Kong)
Number of units affected by redevelopment	About 1 497 households About 120 ground floor shops



- ○ many did not give accurate descriptions in (b)(i), therefore were not able to provide relevant and appropriate suggestions for minimising the adverse impacts brought about by redevelopment
- ○ some suggested offering help to residents and shop owners but failed to provide the idea of keeping those activities within the same district

Section C – Question 3

(c) Refer to Figure 3c and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

Account for the location advantages of the residential development project in area Y.

(3 marks) **Satisfactory**

- ✓ most showed an understanding that the pleasant living environment was one of the major location advantages of area Y
- ○ many did not refer to the map provided
- ○ just directly copied information from Figure 3c without any further explanation





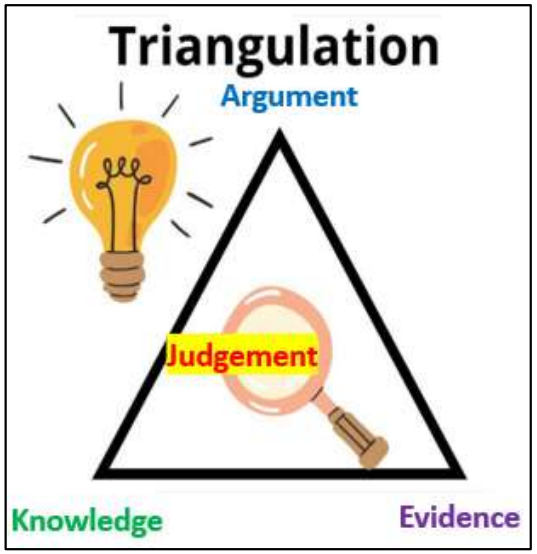
Section C – Question 3

(d) Refer to Figure 3a, Photograph 3b, Figure 3c and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

Discuss whether redevelopment in area X is more economically and environmentally sustainable than the development project in area Y. (4 marks) **Poor**

Marking criteria:

Logical and well-elaborated explanation/argument with reference to the information provided, demonstrating good knowledge and understanding of economic and environmental sustainability of redevelopment in area X and the development project in area Y, with appropriate judgement



Section C – Question 3

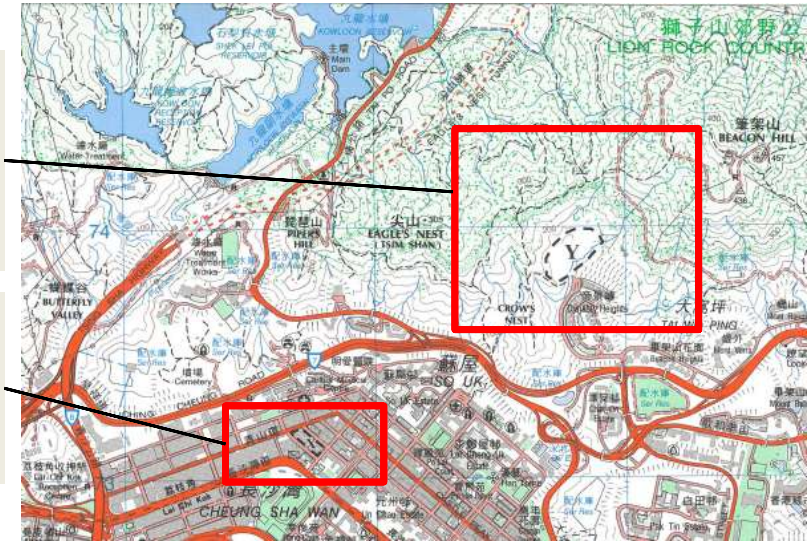
(d) Refer to Figure 3a, Photograph 3b, Figure 3c and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

Discuss whether redevelopment in area X is more economically and environmentally sustainable than the development project in area Y. (4 marks)

✓ attempted to assess the sustainability of redevelopment and the development project from both economic and environmental perspectives

Environmental: e.g. impact on natural environment

Economic: e.g. business opportunities



Section C – Question 3

- some explanations were superficial and not relevant to economic sustainability
- just focused on short-term impacts,
  e.g. pollution caused during the construction or redevelopment processes
- did not show a clear understanding of sustainability

Section C – Question 4

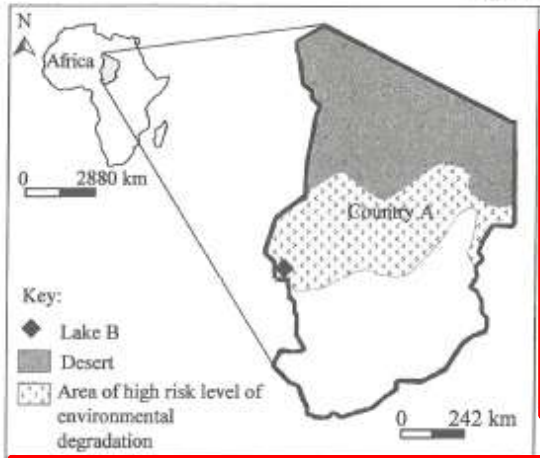
Popularity: 86%

(a) Refer to Figure 4a.

(i) Describe the climatic constraints on agricultural activity P in country A. (3 marks) **Excellent**

(ii) Explain how agricultural activity P in country A adapts to the climatic constraints mentioned in (a)(i). (4 marks) **Very Good**

Figure 4a





Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temperature (°C)	21.2	23.9	27.6	30.9	32.0	31.7	30.1	28.9	29.4	28.4	25.0	22.1
Rainfall (mm)	0	0	0	7	22	34	80	123	61	19	0	0

- ✓ showed strong understanding of how nomadic herding helps people adapt to the climatic constraints
  e.g. rearing small amounts of livestock, drought-resistant species like camels
- ○ some gave lengthy descriptions of the practice of transhumance without addressing how it helped people adapt to the climatic constraints

Section C – Question 4

(b) Refer to Figures 4a and 4b. Explain how the change in the water surface area of lake B was influenced by

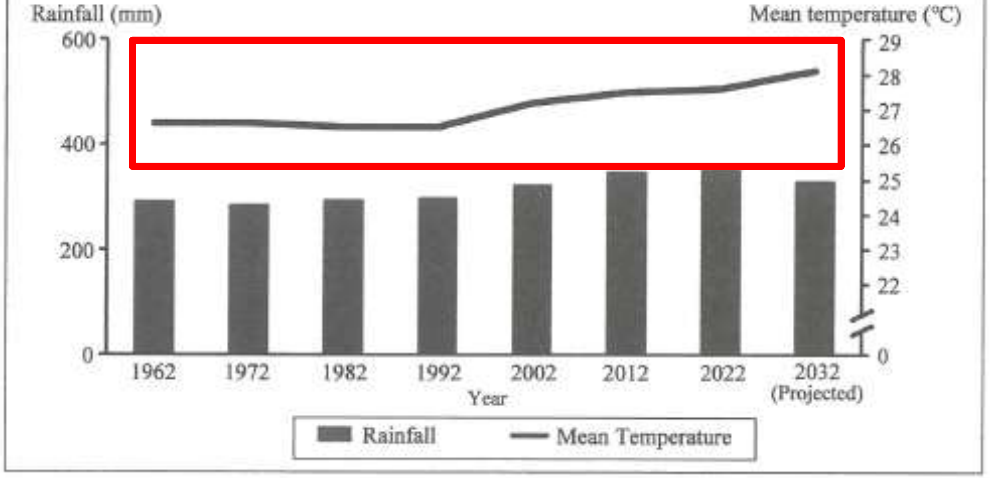
(i) the change in the number of livestock in country A; and (4 marks) **Excellent**

(ii) the climatic trend shown in Figure 4b. (3 marks) **Good**

- ✓ accurate explanation of the increase in the number of livestock leading to a reduction in the water surface area of the lake
- ✓ described the rising trend in mean temperature and explained its impact on evapotranspiration
- ○ failed to recognise the continuity of rising mean temperatures
- ○ unable to address how long-term changes in potential evapotranspiration and low annual rainfall reduce the water surface area of the lake

Figure 4b

	1963	2022
Water surface area of lake B (km^2)	25 000	2 475
Number of livestock (in millions)	8.8	138.7



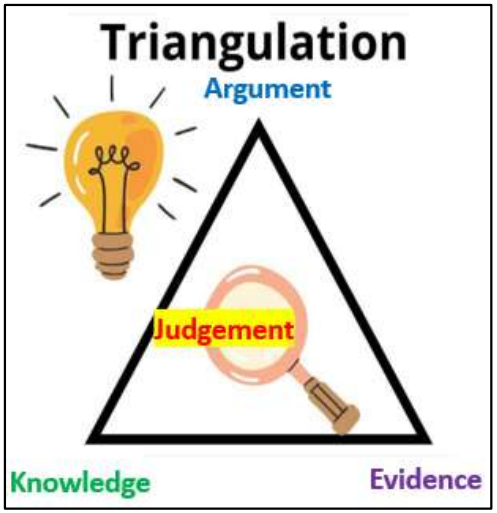
Section C – Question 4

(c) Refer to Figures 4a, 4b and 4c. Discuss whether conservation measure X shown in Figure 4c helps achieve sustainability of agricultural activity P in country A.

(4 marks) **Fair**

Marking criteria:

Logical and well-elaborated explanation/argument which refers to the information provided, demonstrating good knowledge and understanding of the conservation measure X and the feasibility of achieving agricultural sustainability of activity P with the use of the measure, with appropriate judgement



Section C – Question 4

(c) Refer to Figures 4a, 4b and 4c. Discuss whether conservation measure X shown in Figure 4c helps achieve sustainability of agricultural activity P in country A.

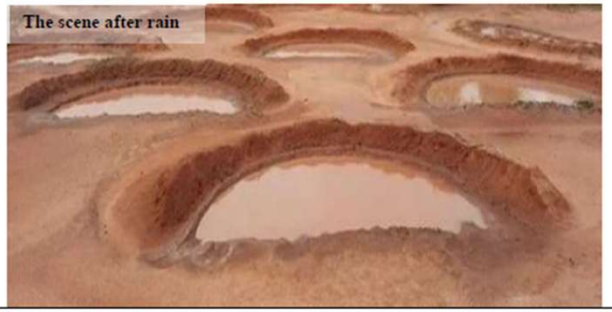
(4 marks) **Fair**

- ✓ correctly identified conservation measure X
- ✓ briefly stated its pros and limitations
- ✓ logical discussion of its effectiveness based on the physical constraints

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temperature (°C)	21.2	23.9	27.6	30.9	32.0	31.7	30.1	28.9	29.4	28.4	25.0	22.1
Rainfall (mm)	0	0	0	7	22	34	80	123	61	19	0	0

Figure 4c





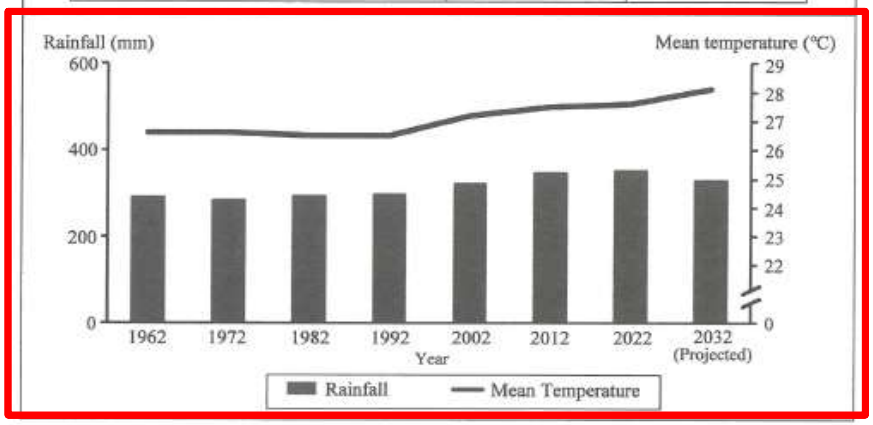
Section C – Question 4

- some wrongly argued that the measure might benefit arable farming
- did not discuss specifically how the measure aided in water and soil conservation helped in achieving the sustainability of agricultural activity P in country A

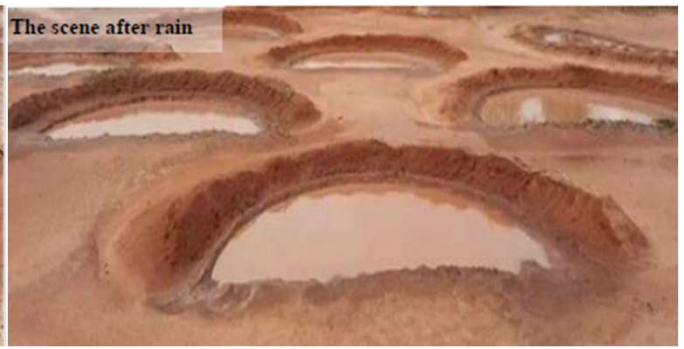
Agricultural activity P



	1963	2022
Water surface area of lake B (km^2)	25 000	2 475
Number of livestock (in millions)	8.8	138.7







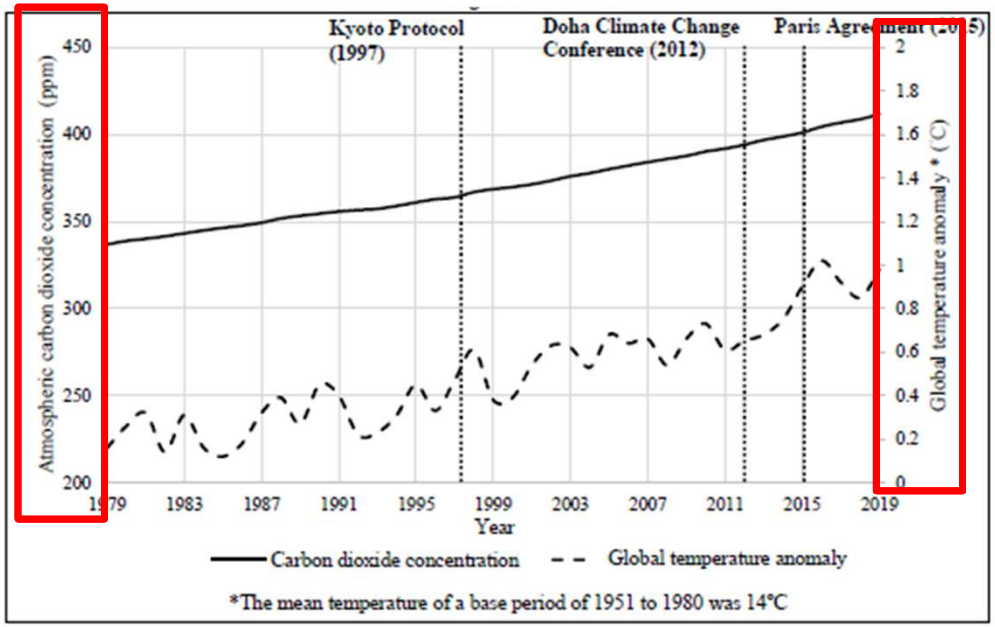
Section C – Question 5

Popularity: 64%

(a) Refer to Figure 5a.

(i) Compare the trends of atmospheric carbon dioxide concentration and the global temperature anomaly between 1979 and 2019. (2 marks)

Poor



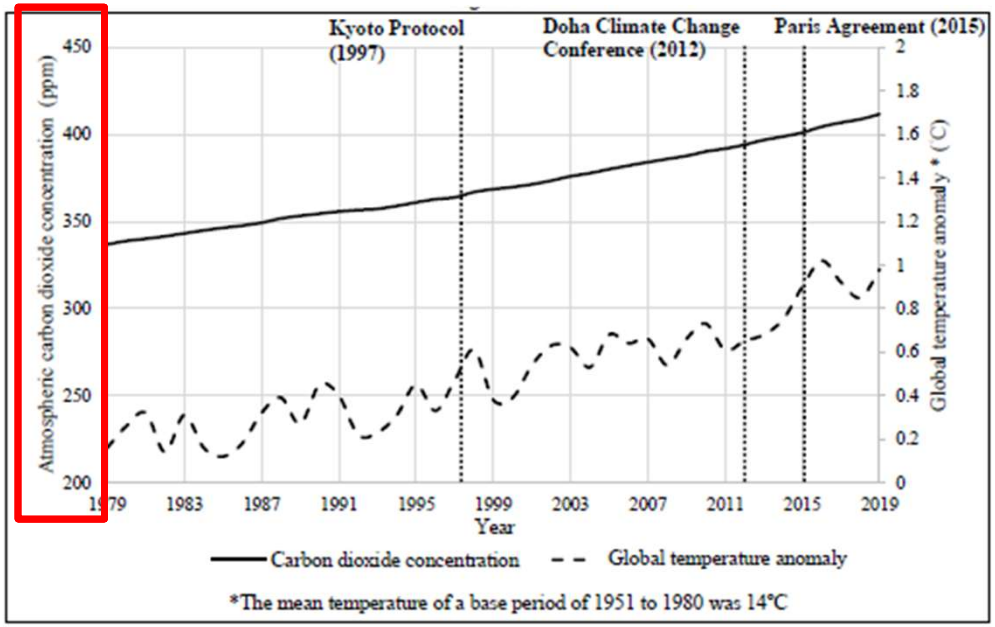
- ✓ recognised the changes in carbon dioxide concentration and global temperature
- ○ did not realise the difference between 'temperature' and 'temperature anomaly'
- ○ did not describe the fluctuation in the rising trend of temperature
- ○ did not compare the rate of increase of carbon dioxide concentration and that of temperature

Section C – Question 5

(a) Refer to Figure 5a.

(ii) Explain the relationship between the trends of atmospheric carbon dioxide concentration and the global temperature anomaly between 1979 and 2019.

(4 marks) **Good**

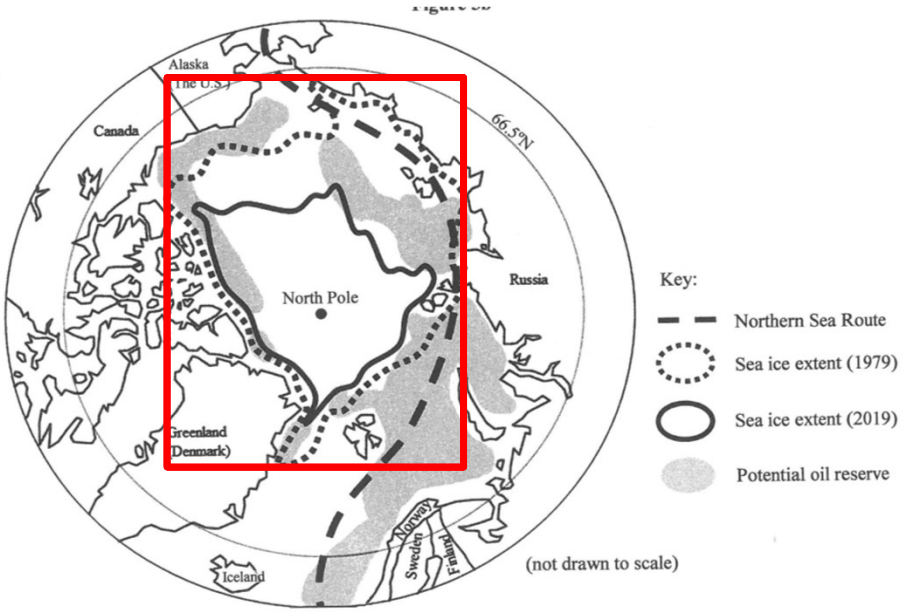


- ✓ identified carbon dioxide as a greenhouse gas
- ✓ demonstrated a clear under-standing of greenhouse effect mechanism
- ○ some did not focus on 'more carbon dioxide' when providing reasons for rising global temperatures
- ○ some confused the concepts of 'radiation' and 'reflection'

Section C – Question 5

(b) Refer to Figures 5a and 5b. How does the change in the extent of Arctic sea ice lead to the global temperature anomaly? (5 marks) **Fair**

- ✓ gave brief explanations of how changes in sea ice extent affect ocean water and contribute to rising global temperatures
- ○ some incorrectly stated that melting sea ice would ease oil extraction, leading to an increase in the burning of fossil fuel and thus exacerbating climate change
- ○ some incorrectly introduced the melting of ice caps or glaciers instead of the shrinking of the Arctic sea ice extent



Section C – Question 5

(c) Refer to Figure 5b. Explain the possible adverse impacts on the countries in the Arctic brought about by the change in the extent of Arctic sea ice. (3 marks)

Poor

- did not read the question and consider the context given carefully, e.g. higher crop yield
- provided explanations of the 'benefits' associated with the shrinking Arctic sea ice extent, e.g. more offshore oil drilling
- some confused 'ice caps and glaciers' with 'sea ice', thus giving irrelevant answers, e.g. inundation of coastal settlements

Section C – Question 5

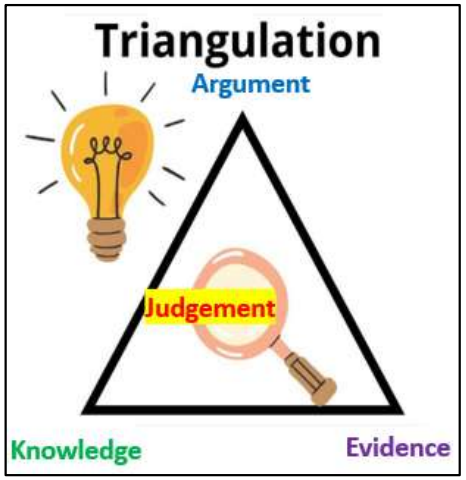
(d) *The Paris Agreement's main goal is to keep the increase in global average temperature to below 1.5°C. above pre-industrial levels until 2100.*

Refer to Figure 5a, Figure 5b and Table 5c. Discuss whether it is feasible to reach this goal through international cooperation. (4 marks)

Fair

Marking criteria:

Logical and well-elaborated explanation/argument which refers to the information provided, demonstrating good knowledge and understanding of climate change and the feasibility of achieving the goal through international cooperation, with appropriate judgement



Section C – Question 5

- ✓ demonstrated a general understanding of international cooperation
- ✓ referred to Table 5c only and gave simple argument, e.g. high investment in renewable energy from MDCs could help LDCs reduce CO^2 concentration (without further elaboration on how the goal could be achieved)

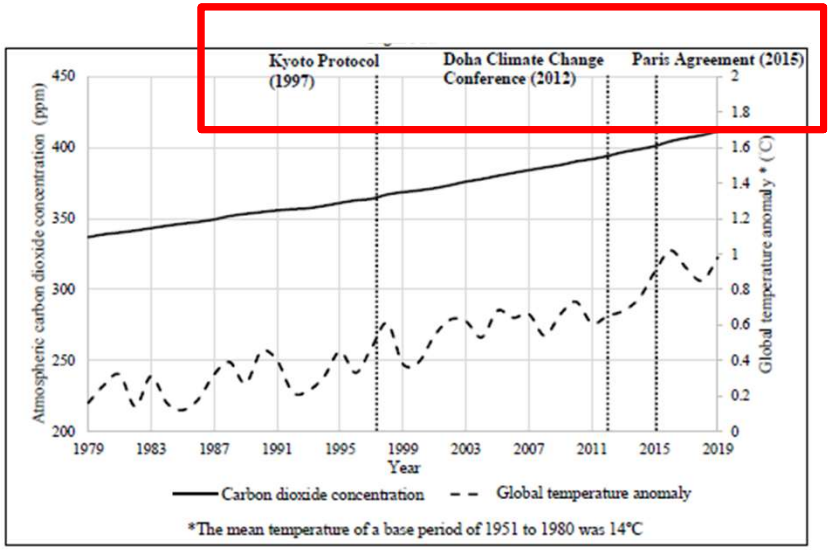
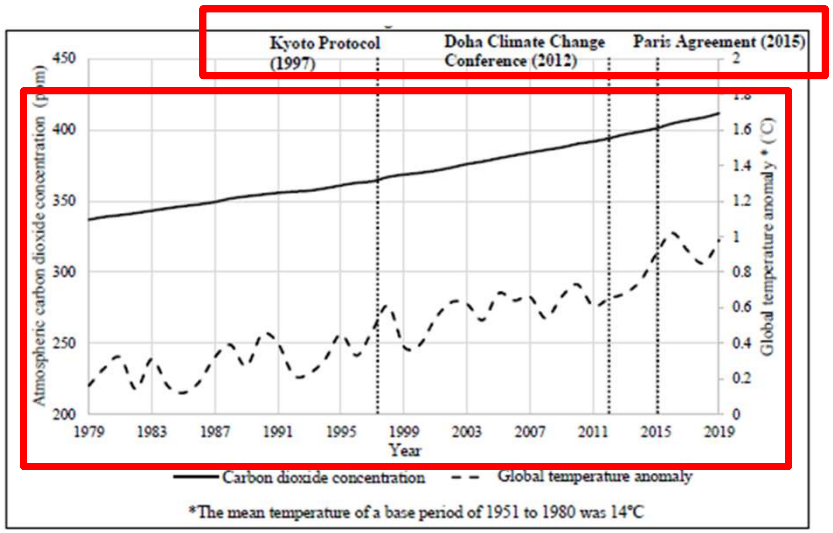


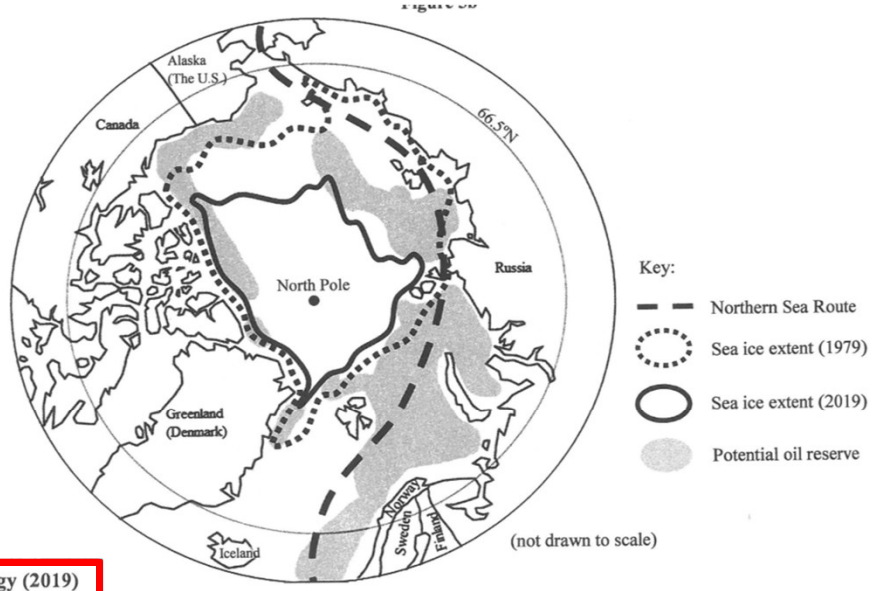
Table 5c

Region	GDP per capita (2019) (USD)	Investment in renewable energy (2019) (USD billion)
Africa	5 000	9.0
Europe	43 000	58.4
Latin America and the Caribbean	15 000	19.9
North America	61 000	56.0

Section C – Question 5

- many argued that it was not feasible to reach the goal but arguments were commonly general, e.g. concerns over 'fairness', 'international agreements are non-binding' (without referring to the figures given)
- failed to consider the practical steps and challenges involved in achieving effective international cooperation





Region	GDP per capita (2019) (USD)	Investment in renewable energy (2019) (USD billion)
Africa	5 000	9.0
Europe	43 000	58.4
Latin America and the Caribbean	15 000	19.9
North America	61 000	56.0

General comments and recommendations (Section C)

1. Most candidates understood the expected standards of drawing annotated diagrams from previous examination reports and did well in this part.
2. Candidates should not just copy only the information provided. They should interpret the information and provide further elaboration.
3. When answering the open-ended questions, candidates tended to give lengthy answers. They should utilise the relevant data provided effectively before incorporating their own knowledge, ensuring that their responses are directly relevant to the question and are framed within a well-defined context.

Section D – Question 6

Popularity: 38%
Performance - Fair

Describe and explain how plate movement along different plate boundaries leads to the occurrence of tsunamis. Discuss the effectiveness of early warning systems in reducing the casualties of tsunami-prone areas.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ showed a basic understanding of plate movement ✓ recognised tsunamis as secondary hazards resulting from earthquakes and volcanic eruptions ✓ provided relevant explanations for the formation of earthquakes and volcanic eruptions along different plate boundaries

Section D – Question 6

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	○ overlooked the critical factor that such seismic or volcanic events usually occur under the sea ○ failed to elaborate on key mechanisms, e.g. vertical displacement of the seafloor or underwater landslides ○ inaccurate examples: earthquakes and volcanic eruptions on land or inland (e.g. Iceland)

Section D – Question 6

Describe and explain how plate movement along different plate boundaries leads to the occurrence of tsunamis. Discuss the effectiveness of early warning systems in reducing the casualties of tsunami-prone areas.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	✓ demonstrated an elementary level of understanding of early warning systems ✓ briefly discussed their effectiveness/limitations e.g. a lack of capital and a low level of technology as primary factors contributing to the ineffectiveness of the systems

Section D – Question 6

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	○ arguments were superficial ○ oversimplified the systems (e.g. tsunami siren) without delving into the broader components (e.g. sensor monitoring systems, siren networks, and communication and broadcasting infrastructures) ○ overlooked the scale and complexity of the systems ○ overlooked the importance of regional cooperation

Section D – Question 7

Popularity: 41%
Performance - Fair

Describe and explain the locational factors affecting the spatial distribution of the iron and steel industry in China from the 1950s to 1960s. Discuss the relative importance of technology in causing the spatial changes of the iron and steel industry in China from the 1980s to the 2000s.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ most performed quite well ✓ demonstrated an adequate understanding of some locational factors influencing the spatial distribution of the iron and steel industry in China from the 1950s to the 1960s, e.g. strategic concerns, balancing economic development between inland and coastal cities, etc. ✓ cited concrete examples, e.g. Baotou

Section D – Question 7

Describe and explain the locational factors affecting the spatial distribution of the iron and steel industry in China from the 1950s to 1960s. Discuss the relative importance of technology in causing the spatial changes of the iron and steel industry in China from the 1980s to the 2000s.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	○ overlooked that the iron and steel centres in NE China were still important from the 1950s to the 1960s (e.g. Anshan) ○ provided superficial descriptions, e.g. proximity to iron ore and coal fields (without considering the characteristics of the iron and steel industry as a weight-losing industry) ○ provided irrelevant explanations, e.g. the availability of cheap labour in inland regions

Section D – Question 7

Describe and explain the locational factors affecting the spatial distribution of the iron and steel industry in China from the 1950s to 1960s. Discuss the relative importance of technology in causing the spatial changes of the iron and steel industry in China from the 1980s to the 2000s.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	✓ showed some understanding of technology adapted in the iron and steel industry ✓ described briefly how iron and steel industries have moved to the coastal regions ✓ provided examples of technology e.g. using scrap iron and bulk carriers

Section D – Question 7

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	○ failed to discuss how these advancements influenced spatial changes in the industry and did not provide detailed examples ○ neglected the time frame highlighted in the question (from the 1980s to the 2000s) thus failed to describe the shift of iron and steel industry to S. China ○ some stated factors like the Reform and Opening-up policy, without further elaboration ○ did not address the 'relative importance' and did not mention other supporting factors, e.g. government incentives

Section D – Question 8

Popularity: 18%
Performance - Poor

Describe and explain how plantation changes the vegetation characteristics in tropical rainforests. Discuss the effectiveness of reforestation in restoring the tropical rainforests previously used for plantation.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ fair performance ✓ described the general physical environment of the tropical rainforests ✓ gave very brief description of the features of plantations and its notable changes on vegetation characteristics e.g. the reductions in height and density

Section D – Question 8

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	○ did not elaborate on the alterations in vegetation layers and heights ○ included irrelevant answers about plant characteristics: e.g. drip tips and buttress roots ○ discussed unrelated aspects e.g. habitats, animal species, soil erosion ○ confused plantation with slash-and-burn practices, or merely treated plantation as the act of planting trees

Section D – Question 8

Describe and explain how plantation changes the vegetation characteristics in tropical rainforests. Discuss the effectiveness of reforestation in restoring the tropical rainforests previously used for plantation.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	✓ Only very few were able to address the limitations of reforestation on degraded rainforests

Section D – Question 8

Describe and explain how plantation changes the vegetation characteristics in tropical rainforests. Discuss the effectiveness of reforestation in restoring the tropical rainforests previously used for plantation.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	○ offered shallow discussions and superficial arguments on the effectiveness of reforestation on the tropical rainforests previously used for plantation ○ focused primarily on the impacts of tree planting (similar to afforestation) and failed to consider factors e.g. depleted soil nutrients, long recovery time for the secondary forest ○ included vague references to socio-economic factors in less developed countries (e.g. corruption, low education level, lack of capital) without providing relevant discussions

General comments and recommendations (Section D)

1. When answering short essay questions, many candidates' answers were too brief. They should develop a greater awareness of time management during examinations.
2. They should allocate sufficient time for interpreting and analysing the key focus of the short essay questions. They should also organise their answers logically rather than just recite knowledge that is inapplicable to the question.

Overall comments and recommendations

1. Candidates generally demonstrated a basic knowledge and understanding of all modules, including key geographical concepts.
2. Candidates should read the questions more thoroughly and carefully interpret the wording of the questions. They should select and focus on concepts that are specifically relevant to the question.
3. Candidates should refine their reasoning and discussion skills, ensuring that their responses are directly relevant to the question and are framed within a well-defined context.
4. Candidates should develop a greater awareness of time management during examinations. They should allocate sufficient time for interpreting the data/questions and for organising their answers.

Review of Candidates' Performance

2025 HKDSE Geography
Paper 2

General comments and recommendations

1. Candidates commonly presented large amounts of learned materials.
2. Candidates were weak in evaluating whether the materials were relevant to the content and/or context upon which the question was based.
3. They tended to list, describe or explain separate points, rather than demonstrating the ability to link ideas to sustain a discussion.

General comments and recommendations

4. They were generally weak in analysing spatial phenomena.
5. Candidates should carefully study the examination reports from previous years to avoid repeating incorrect concepts.
6. When answering **data/skill-based structured questions**, candidates should prioritise using and analysing the provided data.
7. For **open-ended questions**, candidates should carefully interpret the main theme or approach of the question and tailor their answers and arguments accordingly.

Section D Question 1

Dynamic Earth

Relevant concepts:

- Rock types in Hong Kong
- Geological features
- People-environment interrelationship
- Internal and external processes

Section D Question 1

Popularity : 40%

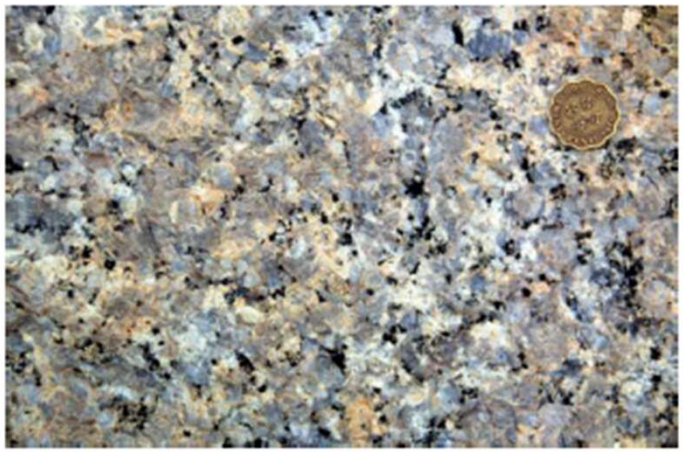
		Performance
(a)	(i)	Excellent
	(ii)	Fair
	(iii)	Good
(b)	(i)	Good
	(ii)	Satisfactory
(c)		Fair

Section D Question 1a (i)

Refer to Figure 1a, Photograph 1b and Photograph 1c. Name **igneous rock X** and describe its characteristics. (3 marks)

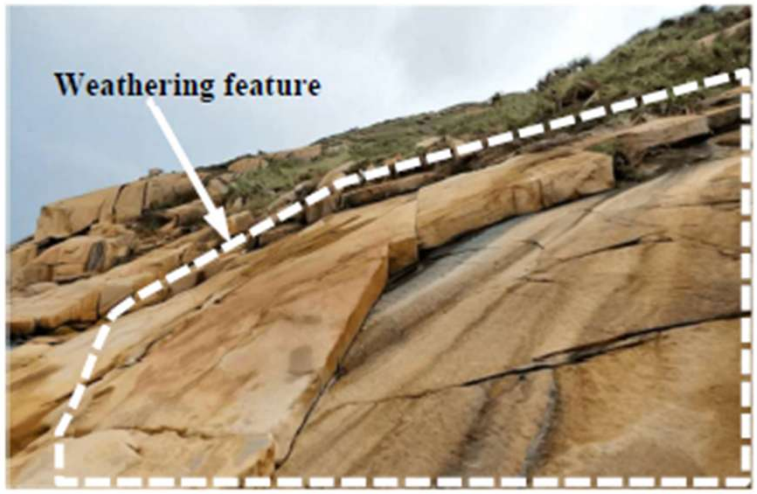
- Most candidates named the rock and described its characteristics correctly.

Photograph 1b



Section D Question 1a (ii)

Explain why the **physical weathering process** shown in Photograph 1c commonly occurs in areas where igneous rock X is found. (5 marks)



- Most candidates failed to identify the physical weathering process.
- They gave answers without referring to the photo provided and limited themselves to listing different physical weathering processes instead.
- Some *mistook temperature change as the cause of rock expansion*.

Section D Question 1a (iii)

Name a potential **geological hazard** associated with the physical weathering process mentioned in (a)(ii). (1 mark)

- Most candidates named the potential geological hazard correctly.
- A small number of candidates spelled 'rockfall' incorrectly or gave a general term with a broader meaning, such as mass wasting.

Section D Question 1b (i)

Refer to Figure 1a.

Describe the **orientation** of the fault. (1 mark)

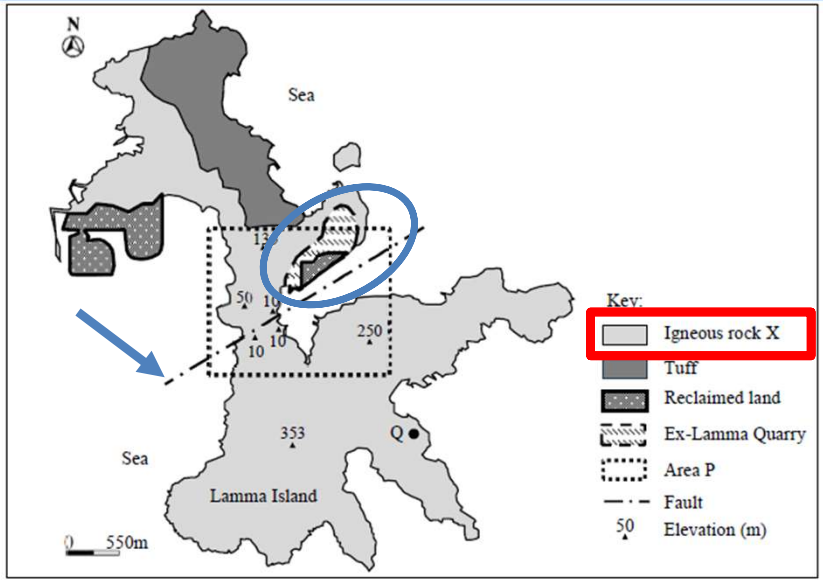
- Most candidates described the orientation of the fault correctly.

Section D Question 1b (ii)

Explain how **faulting shapes the physical landscape** of area P.

(4 marks)

- Many candidates wrongly ascribed the shaping of the landscape to the faulting process directly, rather than the subsequent denudation along the fault, which acts as a line of weakness.
- Some incorrectly associated the resultant landform features, such as rift valleys and block mountains with faulting in the area.
- Very few candidates seemingly understood that the inlet aligned with the orientation of the fault.



Section D Question 1c

To make good use of land resources, there was a proposal to develop the Ex-Lamma Quarry into a low-density residential area.

Refer to Figure 1a, Photograph 1b and Photograph 1d. With reference to the physical and human settings of the Ex-Lamma Quarry, **discuss the feasibility of the proposal**. (4 marks)

Photograph 1d



Section D Question 1c

- Most candidates identified sea view as a positive factor for low-density residential development.
- Some candidates did not interpret the information correctly when discussing the feasibility of developing the ex-quarry site.
- They commonly stated that the weathering of granite contributed to construction challenges, including potential landslides, whereas coastal areas were vulnerable to flooding or tsunamis.
- They even stated that tectonic hazards would happen due to the presence of the fault.

Section D Question 2

Weather and Climate

Relevant concepts:

- Energy budget (factors affecting insolation)
- Atmospheric circulation (global pressure pattern)

Section D Question 2

Popularity : 27%

		Performance
(a)	(i)	Excellent
	(ii)	Good
	(iii)	Fair
(b)	(i)	Satisfactory
	(ii)	Fair

Section D Question 2a (i)

Refer to Figures 2a and 2b. **Match** lines A and B with cities X and Y. (1 mark)

- Most candidates matched the lines A and B with cities X and Y correctly.

Figure 2a

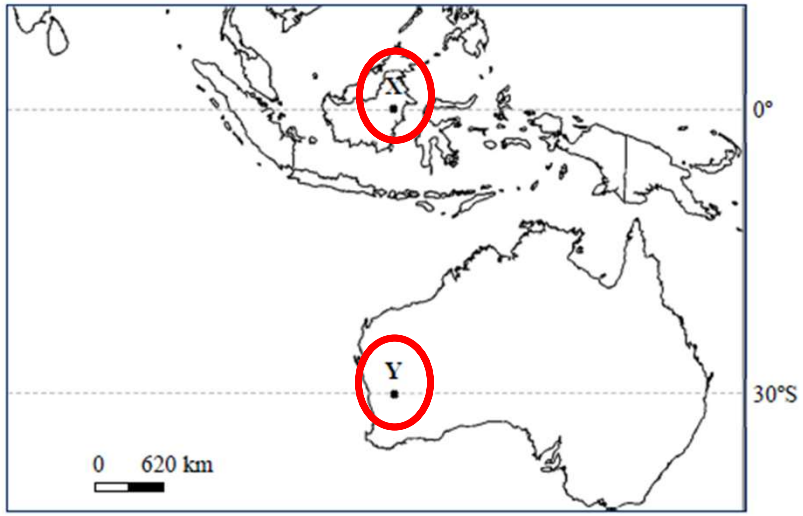
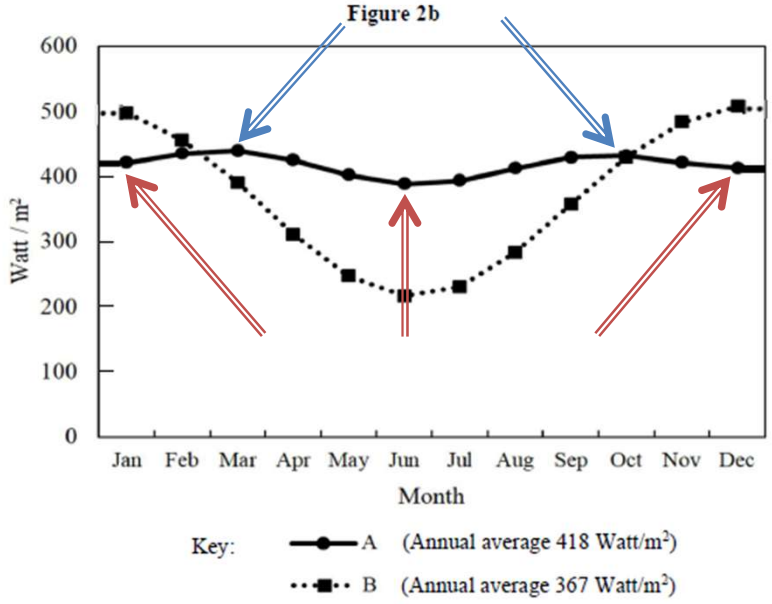


Figure 2b



Section D Question 2a (ii)

Describe the **characteristics of insolation** of city X. (3 marks)

- Most candidates correctly described the amount and annual variation of insolation of city X.
- However, some candidates failed to identify the months of the lowest and highest amount of insolation accurately.
- As regards the annual variation, they often mentioned 'summer' or 'winter' which do not apply to the equatorial latitude.

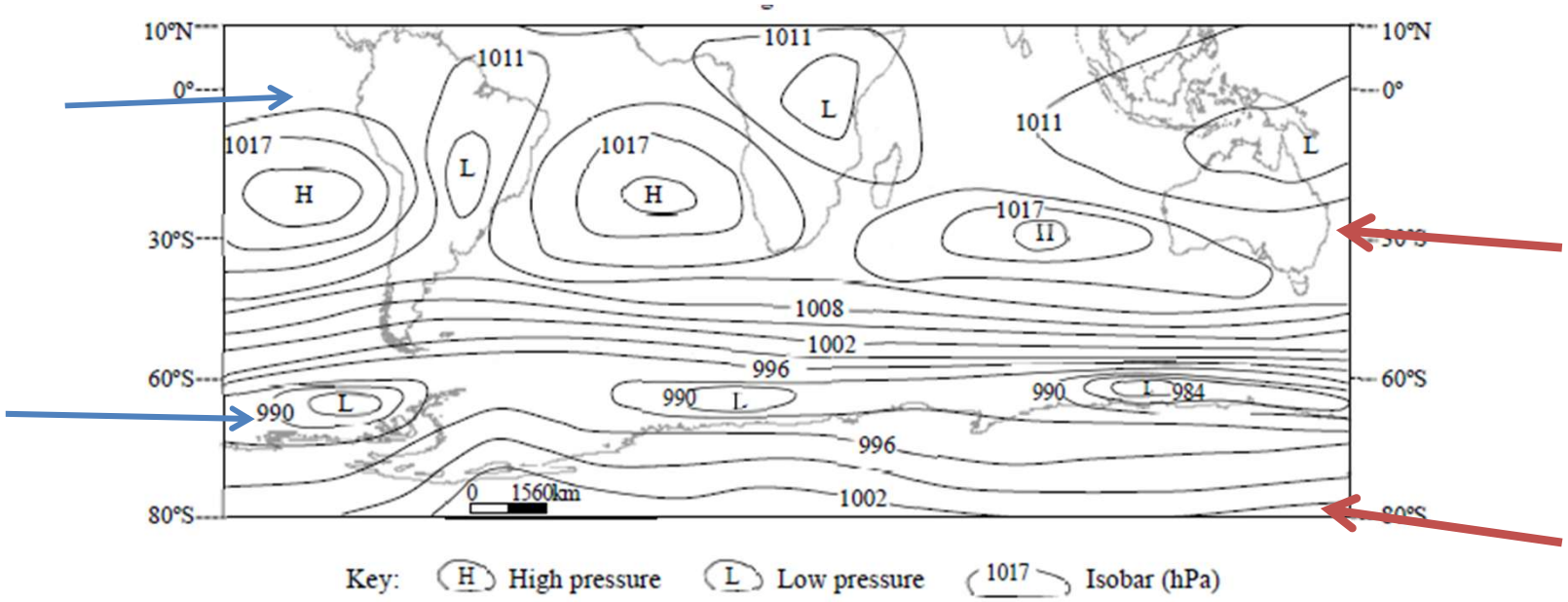
Section D Question 2a (iii)

Explain the **characteristics of insolation** of city X mentioned in (a)(ii). (6 marks)

- Most candidates correctly explained the insolation characteristics by referring to the greater angle of insolation and the shorter distance of sun rays traversing the atmosphere at the Equator.
- Many candidates missed the essential element of 'all year round' in explaining the insolation characteristics at the Equator.
- Some candidates did not specify the two solstices when the overhead sun is at the Tropic of Cancer and Tropic of Capricorn.
- There was a *common misconception that 'the atmosphere is thinner at the Equator'*.

Section D Question 2b (i)

Refer to Figure 2c. Describe the **air pressure pattern in the Southern Hemisphere** in January. (4 marks)



Section D Question 2b (i)

- Most candidates were able to provide a general description of the air pressure pattern.
- However, some candidates failed to give the precise latitudinal location of the pressure belts.
- A small number of candidates only gave a brief description, for example ‘the increasing pressure with increasing latitude’ and ‘the pressure is low in Southern Hemisphere’.

Section D Question 2b (ii)

Refer to Figures 2a, 2b and 2c. **Discuss whether insolation is the most important factor** in affecting the air pressure pattern in the Southern Hemisphere in January. (4 marks)

- While discussing the importance of insolation, some candidates gave vague explanations and failed to refer to the air pressure pattern mentioned in the question.
- Only a small number of them recognised the influence of air movement in forming the associated pressure belts.
- Most candidates demonstrated an understanding that the influence of land and sea distribution was another factor.
- However, some gave irrelevant answers such as ocean currents and relief.

Section D Question 3

Transport Development, Planning and Management

Relevant concepts:

- Transport problems
- Traffic management
- Transport planning

Section D Question 3

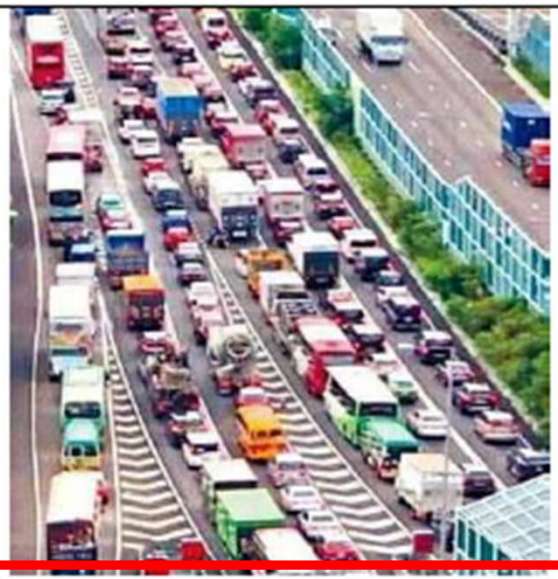
Popularity : 5%

		Performance
(a)	(i)	Good
	(ii)	Fair
(b)	(i)	Satisfactory
	(ii)	Poor
(c)		Fair

Section D Question 3a (i)

Refer to Figure 3a. **State two common transport problems** related to road traffic in Hong Kong. (2 marks)

- Most candidates were able to identify traffic congestion as one of the transport problems.
- But they rarely named air pollution as another problem.

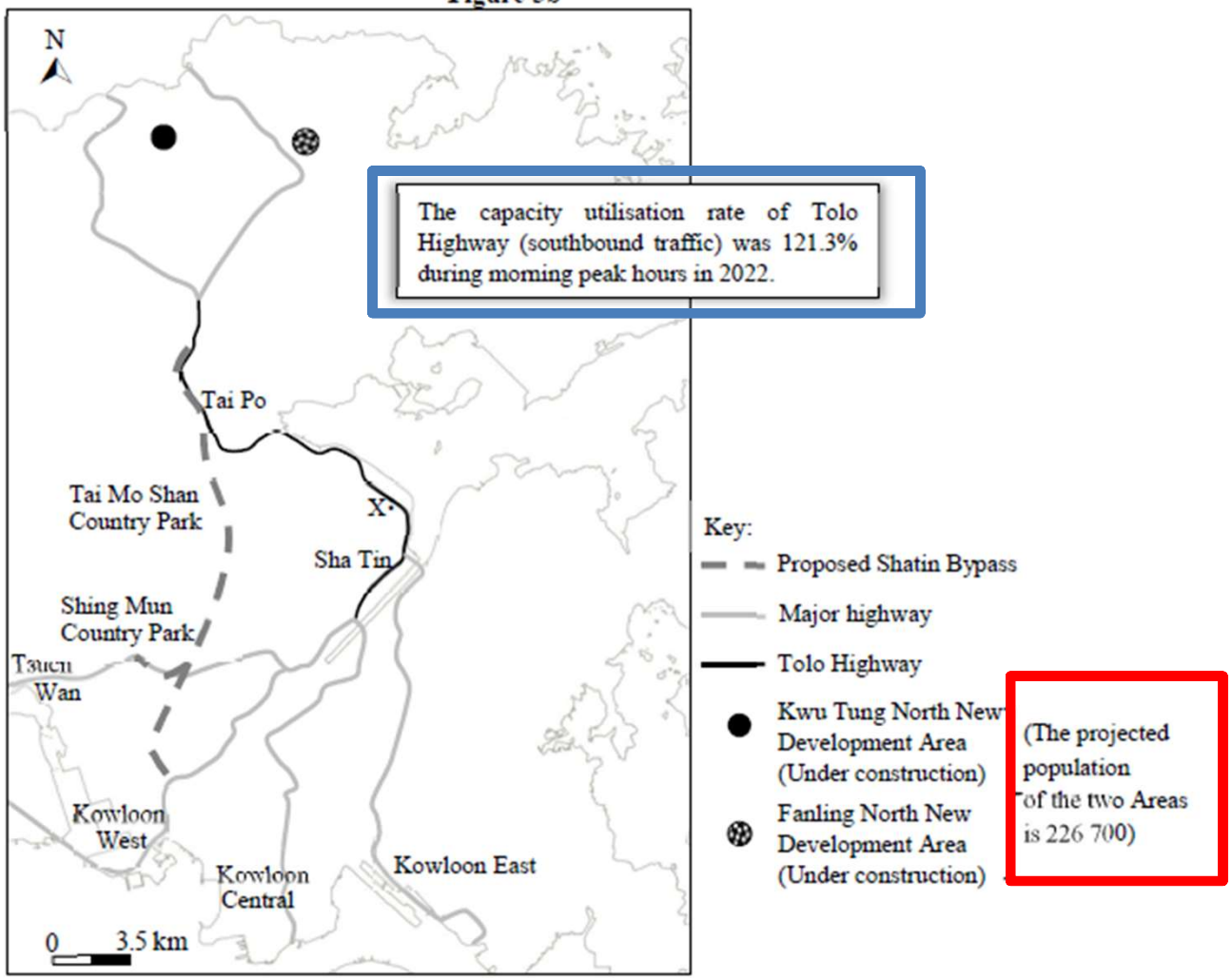


Nitrogen oxides emission from road transport accounted for 19% of Hong Kong's total emissions in 2022.

Section D Question 3a (ii)

Refer to Figure 3b. Explain why the **transport problems** mentioned in (a)(i) occur on **Tolo Highway**. (5 marks)

Figure 3b



Section D Question 3a (ii)

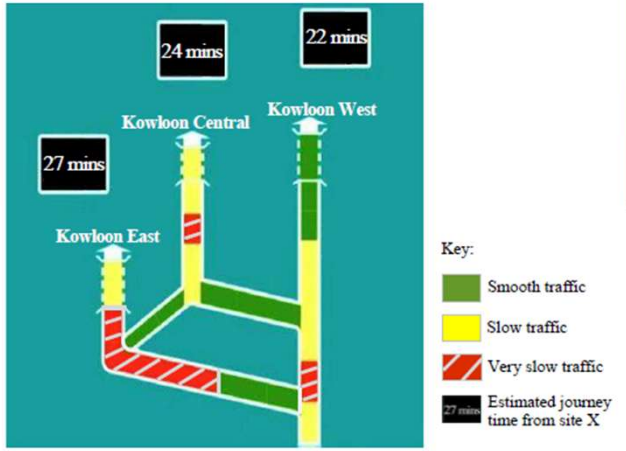
- Most candidates correctly pointed out the fact that as a trunk road connecting the central and north New Territories with Shatin, Tolo Highway accounted for the high traffic load.
- However, many of them mistook the projected population of New Territories North as the cause of the current problem.
- Very few seemingly understood that slow traffic could aggravate air pollution.

Section D Question 3b (i)

Explain how **real-time traffic information can help alleviate the traffic problem** shown in Figure 3c. (4 marks)

- Most candidates were familiar with the real-time traffic information and correctly stated that it helped the public to make informed route choices, thus reducing congestion.
- However, some incorrectly claimed that the information helped commuters shift to other modes of transport, whereas its primary function is to help divert road traffic away from congested routes.

Figure 3c



Section D Question 3b (ii)

Suggest **other traffic management measures** to alleviate the traffic problem on Tolo Highway. (3 marks)

- Many candidates did not specify any traffic management measures.
- Rather, they vaguely stated that the government encouraged the public to switch to other transport modes.
- Some candidates mistakenly considered improvements to transport infrastructure (e.g. building more roads) as management measures.
- Some suggested infeasible measures, for example assigning traffic wardens to guide traffic, increasing public bus routes and setting up bus stops on highways for passengers to transfer to the railway.

Section D Question 3c

Discuss whether the **proposed Shatin Bypass** is appropriate for solving the transport problems on Tolo Highway. (4 marks)

- Most candidates merely explained the benefits of the proposed Bypass in addressing the Tolo Highway congestion, rather than discussing its appropriateness in solving the 'transport problems'.
- Very few were able to address the air pollution issue.
- Very few mentioned, for example, that more private motorists may drive when the Bypass is completed or proposed a mass transit system as an alternative solution to the transport problems on Tolo Highway instead.
- Some mentioned *construction cost and time as factors for discussion, which are not relevant*.

Section D Question 4

Regional study of Zhujiang (Pearl River) Delta

Relevant concepts:

- Factors affecting industrial development
- Changes over time
- Environmental degradation and management

Section D Question 4

Popularity : 28%

		Performance
(a)		Satisfactory
(b)	(i)	Good
	(ii)	Fair
	(iii)	Good
(c)		Satisfactory

Section D Question 4a

Refer to Table 4a. Describe and explain the **changes in high-tech industries** in Dongguan from 2013 to 2022. (5 marks)

		2013	2022
Gross Domestic Product (hundred million RMB)		5 490	11 200
Industrial output*	Cement (million tonnes)	2.5	6.2
	Ceramics for construction (million units)	5.2	0
	Smartphone (hundred million units)	1.4	2
	Electronic component (hundred million units)	10 211	15 600
Number of electronic and communication equipment manufacturing enterprises		811	2 290
Research and development expenditure (hundred million RMB)		98	411
Number of graduates from tertiary education		11 630	36 896
Number of days with excellent and good air quality		246	292
Respirable suspended particulates (PM_{10}) concentration ($\mu g/m^3$) (National concentration limit: 40 $\mu g/m^3$)		69	36
Government policy		• Enhance Environmental Assessment and Management (since 2012) • Provide tax concessions for high-tech industries	

* Enterprises with annual revenue over 20 million RMB

- Most candidates demonstrated some understanding of the general changes in high-tech industries and were able to associate related data to support their explanations.
- However, they did not describe the changes explicitly. Instead of integrating the data, many described and explained the changes item by item based on the table provided.
- Some copied data or wording directly from the table without further elaboration, the government policy for example.

Section D Question 4b (i)

Refer to Table 4a.

Describe **the changes of air quality** in Dongguan. (2 marks)

- Most candidates correctly cited the question data to indicate that the air quality had improved.

Section D Question 4b (ii)

Explain the changes mentioned in (b)(i). (4 marks)

- Many candidates stated the government policy (e.g. Emptying the Cage for New Birds policy) as the reason for the changes in air quality, without using the data provided. They merely focused on *'the increase in high-tech industries', instead of the phasing out of high-polluting low-tech industries*.
- A small number recognised that the introduction of green technology was the other key factor contributing to improved air quality.

Section D Question 4b (iii)

Explain the **socio-economic benefits** in Dongguan brought about by the changes mentioned in (b)(i). (3 marks)

- Most candidates correctly explained the socio-economic benefits resulting from improved air quality in Dongguan.

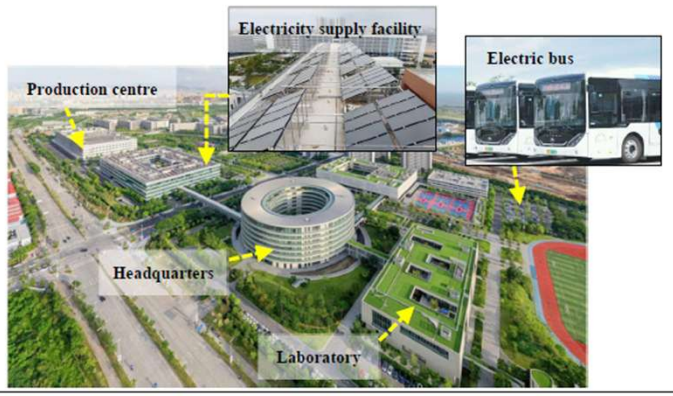
Section D Question 4c

Discuss whether adopting the plan of industrial park X in other cities of Zhujiang Delta Region can further improve the air quality in the region. (4 marks)

- Many candidates diverted from the focus of the question by explaining the general environmental benefits of the industrial park X.
- In addition, confusion was observed in many candidates between *greenhouse gas emissions and air pollution*.
- Their discussions were vague and insufficiently grounded in the ZDR context.

Major product	Smartphone
Mode of operation	Administration, research and development, production, inventory, sales and marketing in the industrial park

Industrial park X



Section D Question 4c

- For example, they argued that ‘only smartphone production was suitable for the park’ and that ‘lots of land and high capital investment were required for the development of the park’.
- Very few were able to address other factors such as regional disparities or other significant sources of air pollution in the region.

Section D Question 5

Popularity : 40%

Performance : Satisfactory

Explain how sedimentary rock and metamorphic rock **transform into each other** in the rock cycle. **Discuss** the relative importance of sedimentary rock in **shaping the physical landscape of the northeastern part of Hong Kong.**

Relevant concepts:

- Rock cycle
- Rock types
- Geological features, spatial distribution

Section D Question 5 Part 1

- Most candidates were able to explain the formation of sedimentary and metamorphic rocks accurately.
- Some gave a comprehensive account of sedimentary rock formation, clearly outlining the complete process.
- However, a small number of candidates merely listed the processes without further elaboration.
- Most candidates correctly identified the three modes of formation of metamorphic rocks: dynamic metamorphism, thermal metamorphism and regional metamorphism.

Section D Question 5 Part 1

- Nonetheless, there was some confusion regarding the processes involved, such as the recrystallisation of minerals and a few examples were incorrectly named.
- Some answers did not meet the requirement of the question, i.e. explaining 'how the two types of rocks transformed into each other'.
- A small number of candidates confused the formation processes of metamorphic and igneous rocks, wrongly including igneous rocks in the transformation sequence. This was deemed irrelevant to the question.

Section D Question 5 Part 2

- Most candidates demonstrated an unclear understanding of the geographical extent of the northeastern part of Hong Kong.
- When discussing the relative importance of sedimentary rock, many candidates mistakenly compared sedimentary rock to other rock types that were mostly found outside the defined area, for example the inclusion of tuff from the Sai Kung area. Some even extended the area to include igneous rocks in Tai Mo Shan.
- However, some candidates were able to name typical examples such as Pat Sin Leng, Ping Chau and Bride's Pool Waterfall, successfully linking the characteristics of sedimentary rock to the physical landscape.

Section D Question 5 Part 2

- Coastal erosional landform features at the local scale were also mentioned.
- However, some failed to relate these features to the properties of the parent rock, which was essential for a complete explanation.
- In addition, some showed an understanding that faulting (e.g. Tolo Channel Fault) is another significant factor.
- Very few candidates acknowledged the influence of exogenic processes, such as weathering and erosion, in shaping the physical landscape.
- A small number of candidates mentioned human influences, which were not appropriate in the context of physical landscape formation, as required by the question.

Section D Question 6

Popularity : 26%

Performance : Satisfactory

Compare the formation of convection rain and frontal rain. **Discuss** the relative importance of the **monsoon system** in affecting the **rainfall characteristics in Hong Kong**.

Relevant concepts:

- Humidity and condensation (precipitation)
- Monsoon
- Weather system

Section D Question 6 Part 1

- Most candidates demonstrated a general understanding of the formation of convection rain and frontal rain, although some failed to make a clear comparison between the two.
- In general, the similarities, such as cloud and rain formation, were well explained.
- Regarding the differences, a few misconceptions were spotted.
- For example, as warm air rises, it cools at higher altitudes and eventually sinks. However, some students wrongly identified the sinking of cool air as the driving force behind convection.
- 'The rise of air' as an essential prerequisite for convection rain formation, is primarily due to surface heating and not air convergence, as some candidates argued.

Section D Question 6 Part 2

- Most candidates provided a detailed explanation of the formation of the monsoon system, correctly identifying the development of onshore winds in summer and offshore winds in winter, which led to increased rainfall in summer and reduced rainfall in winter.
- However, only a few extended their discussion to other rainfall characteristics, such as annual rainfall.
- Many candidates cited other weather systems such as tropical cyclones, cold fronts and troughs of low pressure as contributing to rainfall in Hong Kong.
- However, they commonly failed to explain how these systems influenced specific rainfall characteristics, including seasonal patterns, frequency and intensity.

Section D Question 6 Part 2

- Some candidates mentioned geographical factors like distance from the sea, latitude and relief.
- However,they generally did not explain the influence of such factors on rainfall characteristics accurately or in sufficient depth.
- For example, ‘locations near the sea would not bring more rainfall’ and ‘higher evaporation at warmer low latitude’.

Section D Question 7

Popularity : 5%

Performance : Poor

With reference to the **land rent theory**, **describe and explain** the **impact of transport on urban land use**. **Comment** on the significance of **railway network** development in affecting the **location of residential land use** in the New Territories.

Relevant concepts:

- Accessibility
- Distance decay
- Urban and transport planning

Section D Question 7 Part 1

- Very few candidates demonstrated a good understanding of the land rent theory.
- Many answers unsuccessfully tried to explain how high and low land rent influenced different types of urban land use. This was commonly based on a misunderstanding of the term 'land rent'.
- The impact of transport on urban land use was narrowly interpreted as being typically limited to the presence of commercial or residential land uses near bus stops or railway stations.
- The concept of 'land use competition' based on accessibility or distance from the city centre was largely misunderstood.

Section D Question 7 Part 2

- Most candidates showed a limited understanding of the railway network in the New Territories. They simply named a place of residence with a railway station without further explanation. Neither was knowledge related to the functions and advantages of a railway network evident.
- The concept of transit-oriented development, especially the development of high-density residential areas near railway stations, was absent from most answers.
- In addition, other important factors influencing residential land use distribution, such as road networks, urban planning strategies and public housing development were commonly overlooked.

Section D Question 8

Popularity : 27%

Performance : Fair

Describe and explain the problems faced by the agricultural sector in Zhujiang Delta Region **since 2000**. **Discuss** the effectiveness of **precision farming** in combating these problems in the long run.

Relevant concepts:

- Factors affecting agricultural development
- Changes over time

Section D Question 8 Part 1

- Most candidates were able to list two or more problems faced by the agricultural sector in the Zhujiang Delta Region (ZDR).
- However, many of them failed to provide clear explanations. A common error was overlooking the specified time frame 'since 2000' and instead citing outdated policies or developments from the 1980s, such as the Reform and Opening-up policy and the One-child policy.
- A few mentioned the Emptying the Cage for New Birds policy. However, its impact on agriculture was generally misunderstood or poorly explained.

Section D Question 8 Part 1

- Candidates were familiar with the general impacts of urbanisation and industrialisation on agriculture.
- However, the lack of ZDR-specific examples limited the depth and quality of their answers, precluding many from achieving higher marks.

Section D Question 8 Part 2

- Most candidates showed a basic understanding of precision farming, but they seemingly did not understand how the technology related to precision farming applied in the ZDR. They stated practices such as vertical farming, the use of farming machinery and greenhouses, but they did not clearly demonstrate how these reflected the application of precision farming.
- Many mentioned limitations such as insufficient capital, limited technical knowledge and urban sprawl. These points were often vague and lacked knowledge specific to the ZDR context.

Section D Question 8 Part 2

- A few cited irrelevant technologies, such as genetically modified crops.
- The most common weakness was a lack of connection between the precision farming methods discussed and the specific agricultural problems identified in the first part of the essay.
- For example, some explained how precision farming could protect crops from adverse weather or pests; issues that were not major concerns in the ZDR.

Section D Question 8 Part 2

- Some suggested that controlling fertilizer use could prevent eutrophication. However, this overlooked the fact that water pollution in the ZDR was mainly caused by urban and industrial activities.
- Only very few candidates provided a well-reasoned discussion of how precision farming could effectively address agricultural challenges in the long run.

Q&A

Thank You for Your Participation